

CIS 485 - GROUP CONTRACT

Group Number + Name: Group 1, Liam Nichol

Date: October 1st, 2025

Instructions

1. **Connect with group members.** Contact all members to establish communication.
2. **Schedule a 90-minute meeting.** All members must attend. In-person meetings are strongly recommended.
3. **Prepare in advance.** Each member should review the contract questions beforehand and bring ideas to discuss.
4. **Complete the contract.** During the meeting, write detailed responses to all questions.
5. Signatures required. Each member must sign the document (electronic signatures are acceptable).
6. **Submit one copy.** Only one group member needs to submit the final PDF on behalf of the group.
7. **Instructor approval.** Your assigned instructor will review the submission. Revisions may be required before approval is granted. Approval is mandatory before your group can proceed with the project.

Changelog

Version 1.0: Initial group contract (**Date: 2025-10-01**)

Group Roles

1. What secondary roles will each group member take on (**all group members are counted as Software Developer in their primary role**; their secondary role is an add-on to ensure smooth operation of group flow)
 - a. Secondary roles include (but not limited to): Project Manager (required), Lead Writer, Game Designer, Documentation Lead, Quality Assurance, Graphics designer, etc.
 - b. *Note: One person must take on the role of a **Project Manager** (This is a person in charge of coordinating communication/scheduling meetings between all group members. This individual will also be the liaison between the teaching group and the group. **Having this role does NOT imply more power in decision making over other group members**)*

Liam will be the Lead Writer.

2. How will tasks be assigned and rotated among group members?

First come, first serve. As for rotation, it is on an “as needed” basis, so if a group member is tired of the role, they can swap with someone who is also wanting to swap.

3. Who will be responsible for ensuring that the group meets deadlines?

The Project Manager.

Group Communication

4. What is the preferred method of communication (e.g., email, messaging app, in-person meetings)?

We will use Discord.

5. How often will the group meet, and at what times? Be as specific as possible.

Once a week online on Wednesday night from 7:00 to 8:30.

6. How will the group handle communication with the instructor? (only 1 person should be representing the group)

The Project Manager will represent the group.

7. What method will be used for setting and following meeting agendas?

- a. Who will set each agenda? When? How will group members be notified/reminded?

The Project Manager gives us a rough outline of an agenda via Discord around Sunday night.

- b. Who will be responsible for the group following the agenda during a group meeting?

The Project Manager can keep the group in line on the agenda.

- c. What will be done to keep the group on track during a meeting?

Everyone is responsible for their focus, but others can intervene if it gets to a severe point.

8. What process will the group use for tracking progress and updates (e.g., project management tools, weekly reports)?

We can use the GitHub dashboard, but also report weekly over Discord.

Group Decision Making

9. How will decisions be made within the group (e.g., consensus, majority vote, leader decision)?

Majority votes will decide.

10. What process will be used if the group is unable to reach a decision? (e.g. how will conflicts or disagreements be resolved?) Be as specific as possible.

If the group is unable to reach another decision, we can try to ask everyone's viewpoint on the matter and then find a solution that would work while benefitting everyone.

Group Work Quality

11. What are the group standards? (What is a realistic level of quality for code, presentations, collaborative writing, individual research, preparation of drafts, peer reviews, etc.?)

The code should work while keeping to everything that is needed for the project.
Our presentations should be structured well, engage the viewer, and communicate the point.
Our individual research should be well-sourced with reputable sources and should be sent in on time to keep the project moving.
Drafts of reports should be looked over by at least one other person.
Peer reviews should provide constructive criticism, but also be kind in how said criticism is delivered.

12. What strategies will be implemented to review and test each other's work?

We will review and test one another's work through use of peer reviews, while also testing the code for the project individually.

Group AI Usage Policy

13. Will the group use AI tools (e.g., code generators, AI-assisted writing, debugging tools) in the project?
- a. If yes, specify which tools are permitted as part of the group work
 - b. If not, specify the reasons as to why. The following questions in this section can be skipped.

We all mutually agreed at the start of the semester that none of us would use AI as we all prefer to not use it.

14. What are the guidelines for using AI tools to ensure ethical and responsible usage?
15. How will the group ensure that AI-generated content meets the required quality standards and does not violate academic integrity?
- a. How will AI-generated work be reviewed and validated by group members?
 - b. Who will be responsible for verifying the accuracy and quality of AI-assisted outputs?

16. What steps will be taken if AI tools are used inappropriately?
17. What are the consequences of failing to disclose AI usage by a group member to others? (including group members/course teaching team)
18. How will AI usage be factored into assessing individual contributions?

Group Participation and Accountability

19. What are the expectations for attendance at meetings and participation in group activities?

Unless life conflicts with time, all members must attend scheduled group meetings.

20. What is the expected level of contribution from each group member?

Each group member has an equal part that they need to do, so each member must do their portion.

21. How will the group address situations where a member is not contributing equally?
Be as specific as possible.

The group will warn the group member before reporting to the instructor if the contribution is hindering the progress of the project.

22. What is the expected level of communication of each group member? What is the expected response time (provide a specific number, e.g. hours, days, etc.)

Each group member is given at least 24-48 hours to respond to messages, and even then, each member should still be active on the Discord.

23. How will the group ensure (minor and major) deadlines are met?

A timeline will be set up so that any changes will not be final hour changes, but rather that we finish the deadlines a week before they are due.

Group Conflict Resolution / Consequence for Failing to Meet Expectations

Note: You MUST develop a team-based process to resolve conflicts internally before contacting the instructor.

24. What steps will the group take if a conflict arises that the group cannot resolve internally?

If a conflict can't be resolved, the group shall meet and discuss what steps to take regarding how to deal with the situation.

25. What are the agreed-upon consequences if a group member fails to meet their commitments?

The group member is warned by the group about their commitments (ie. Submitting on time, failing to update group on task progress), but if they do not acknowledge the warning in text (or at least in actions), the task will go to another group member and the Project Manager or another group member will message the professor over a possible removal of the group member should the behaviors continue.

26. How will the group handle continued infractions or lack of participation by a group member?

Continued infractions of lack of participation by a group member, even after being warned, will lead to the group member being removed after talking to the professor.

Signatures

I have actively contributed to the development of the standards, roles, and procedures outlined in this contract, ensuring that they reflect the collective expectations and goals of the group. I fully acknowledge my responsibility to adhere to all the terms and conditions specified within this document. I understand that my commitment to these terms is essential for the success of the group and the quality of our collective work.

Furthermore, I am aware that any failure on my part to comply with these agreed-upon terms will result in the enforcement of the specified consequences, which may include reassignment of roles, reduction of individual grades, or other measures necessary to maintain the integrity of the group's work. Additionally, I understand that the teaching group reserves the right to impose further penalties, such as grade deductions or formal warnings, in response to any breaches of this contract.

By signing below, I affirm my commitment to these responsibilities and the success of our group.

Full Name	Signature	Date
Liam Nichol	Liam Nichol	2025-10-01

--	--	--